

8.3.7 DMZ

Demilitarised Zone. A term borrowed from the army, the demilitarised zone in technology is a computer or a small network inserted between the company's private LAN and the public Internet. This is used to prevent and trap hackers from getting at company information that resides securely in the private LAN. When hackers manage to break through the first layer of security, they would in all likelihood be trapped inside the DMZ under the false impression that they are within the actual private network. This sense of false security will give network security professionals sufficient time to track and trace the intrusion attack.

8.3.8 DNS

Domain Name System or Domain Name Service. Every domain name on the Internet has an associated IP address. The link between the IP address and the domain name is managed by the domain registry service at the InterNic, a global organisation. When a user types in a domain name—say thinkdigit.com—what happens is that a query is sent to the Domain Registry asking for the IP address of thinkdigit.com. This query and its resolution are handled by the DNS.

8.3.9 E-Commerce

The business of transacting on the Net, where transactions are carried out in real-time or quasi-real-time. For example, a valid e-commerce site would be one that sells various products online and allows the buyer to pay by credit card.

8.3.10 EDI

Electronic Data Interchange. EDI was the forerunner to the Internet and acted as an electronic means by which trading partners could share information and transact with each other. In some instances, the systems were so set up that when an item reached below a specified quantity of stock, automatic purchase orders were released from one company to the next via EDI. The receiving company would ship the item and inform via EDI that the items were shipped. While EDI is quite old technology, there